This symmetrical triangle is what I call a 5% failure. Price moves no more than 5% away from the breakout price before trending in a new direction (downward in this case). When price closes below the bottom of the triangle, it busts the upward breakout, too.

Look at the right pattern. Is it a valid symmetrical triangle? Price crosses the pattern from top to bottom a few times. Volume recedes as one would expect. However, there are only four trendline touches, not five. When price pierces the lower trendline, it's not a minor low touch that's inside the trendline (we'd have to redraw the trendline to include the minor low, and that would invalidate the triangle, too). The April pattern is not a valid symmetrical triangle.

Statistics

This just in: **Table 66.2** shows general statistics for symmetrical triangles. It's true!

Number found. I located 4,085 triangles in 1,011 stocks with the first in May 1988 and the most recent in April 2019. Not all stocks covered the entire period, and some no longer trade. Most of the patterns appear in bull markets, but that's only because they are longer (and more of them) than bear markets.

Reversal (R), continuation (C) occurrence. The trend columns (bull market/up breakout, bear market/down breakout) have the most triangles acting as continuation patterns (like swimming with the current). The countertrend columns, the two inner ones, show more reversals than continuations as price struggles trying to swim against a current.

Reversal/continuation performance. Reversals perform slightly better than continuations for upward breakouts. Downward breakouts don't show a significant performance difference.

Average rise or decline. The average rise is a disappointing 34% in bull markets. This figure is well off the pace set by other chart pattern types (average: 42.4%). The other columns also show below-average performance when compared to other patterns.